

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 4

ARIZONA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arizona's family courts and child-welfare system.

97

ARIZONA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 179
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 15 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 19, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
14 OF 15

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARIZONA AT A GLANCE.

Across 97 Arizona families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
179
96 of 97 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$182,080
median across 50 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
15
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
50.5%
49 of 97 who answered; 42 of 97 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
97	1.9	96 of 97	14

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arizona families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

02 THE COST OF ARIZONA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	68	$28,000	$82,030	$5,578,039
Lost Wages	48	$20,000	$121,454	$5,829,775
Other Court Fees	38	$1,000	$17,108	$650,120
Therapy / Evaluations	47	$5,000	$11,270	$529,671
Reunification Services	31	$2,000	$3,514	$108,932
GAL Fees	22	$450	$10,186	$224,100
Asset Loss [1]	43	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (50 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$182,080	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	15	1.2 yrs
Mean months lost	28	2.3 yrs
Total across all families	1,936	161.3 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARIZONA

Most families documenting in Arizona are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	48	50%
Case closed: within last 2 years	12	12%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	12	12%
Not provided	12	12%
Active case: progress being made	9	9%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	44	45%
Both Family Court and CPS	38	39%
CPS Only	12	12%
Unknown	3	3%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	35	36%
5 – 10 years	23	24%
3 – 5 years	15	16%
Over 10 years	9	9%
6 months – 1 year	8	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

50/50 Joint	32	33%
Visitation Only	23	24%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	22	23%
Full Custody	10	10%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)	6	6%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Maricopa	48	57%
Pima	8	10%
Mohave	7	8%
Yavapai	6	7%
Pinal	5	6%
Usa	2	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	39	40%
High Conflict Divorce	18	19%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	12	12%
Other	10	10%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	7	7%

04 PARENT VOICES — ARIZONA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Arizona comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *My abusive, dx NPD, undx ASPD, never-working ex, his flying monkeys, corrupt CPS (who ignored court interviewer, kids' teacher, and my kids but should have helped us get free from my ex) and corrupt family court have completely and totally destroyed my children, our loving [...]*
>
> — ELISABETH

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Holidays, religious and cultural ties maliciously fractured, birthday, sporting events, special milestones were taken. Total erasure of a safe and loving parent, parental alienation through other party manipulation, isolating child with coercice control breaking child's cultural [...]

— ARIZONA PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM ARIZONA

We have been alienated from each other, I was forced to abandon, because of threats and interigation tactics to my children. I cant control what cps is doing to my children, while I am not present in their life, they have to pretend to hate me to appease the father, court, casa [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court and CPS have damaged the mental health of my children. There should be accountability for Judges, Attorneys, Pychologist, to are not doing what is in the best interest of the Children.

— MANUEL

Destroyed it. Evil abuser had everything granted. Children are abused and I'm controlled

— LAUREN

It has destroyed mine and my wife life and we are still crying and wishing that we could be with him and his brothers and sisters that are younger than he is he will be turning 13 in May. I have three other kids ranging from five years old, and 12 years old and my kids love to [...]

— JOHN

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed my family. abused the children. Tortured and extorted me as a father.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have 4 beautiful Daughters, From SA came here in 1999 - Imme grating and fought the court for 15 yrs to get Asylum - Got asylum in 2015 then got Citizenship 2019. Ex has used my children as leverage against me many years. Use them to keep me in line and told my children and [...]

— ESTE

My now adult children are now forever traumatized and broken with anxiety and depression from being ripped away from me for a year. After i was their primary caretaker for the first 10 years of their lives.

— MOLLY

Put my children back in the hands of their abuser

— ELIZABETH

Generationally life changing for children and families because of a corrupt Family Court system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This cost me two years of no contact my son, and it has subjected my son to abuse and has caused him tremendous strain and anxiety

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has taken for beautiful children that will well taken care of from my son and separated them from their grandparents and their family they have no communication with us and we were in their lives since the day they were born now we can't see them we can't speak to him [...]

— JOSETTE

My grandson was suspected to sexual abuse and meth exposure for years. I was not allowed to see him until he was grown

— PATRICIA

Judges ignored DV, financial abuse, coercive control, COA ignored children's testimony of abuse. DCS does nothing but threaten and play devils advocate instead of protecting the child. Judge orders counselors and CIA's to prolong costs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It has destroyed the bond with my son and I and placed him in the hands of a felon*
>
> — MYKELA

They permanently altered my life and my young 3 sons" lives. Not only did they steal our time, which we will never get back, but they let our abuser walk away without any consequences or accountability. The trauma inflicted on us will never leave our story,

— LACEY

The system has used my family to farm out drug testing, behavior health services and then my daughter was thrown to my abuser even though they knew the circumstances. They were "legal kidnappers" in Havana's county. The t-shirts they made can still be seen in photos online

— LEIGH

My babies never experienced trauma until they were removed from my home.

— DANIELA

"I survived abuse only to be betrayed by the very system sworn to protect us. Family Court and CPS punish mothers for protecting their children, twisting fear into guilt and love into crime. They can take my children, but they will never take my truth, my voice, or the justice [...]

— MELISSA

Devastating physical and psychological damage to my son. Years of unimaginable trauma for both us

— MICHELLE

Absolute devastation, PTSD, financial ruin, psychological warfare. The court system has allowed my abusive ex to legally and financially bully and abuse me for years.

— RENEE

They victimized the victim, which was me. I was a victim of dv , abuse, narcissistic control and they came after me. My children's only caretaker. Made my husband a saint.

— DESIREE

Destroyed my family, tore us apart and kept going. it will. be s miracle if our parent child relationship is ever restored.

— SUMMER

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *A donor who leaves for a substantial amount of time even though there is a court order for parenting time should NOT be able to just pick and choose to reappear whenever it's convenient for him and push law enforcement agencies into enforcing orders that the children have not [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Total family annihilation. Financial and emotional.
— SHANNON

My child was medically kidnapped, mentally and physically abused by dcs and phoenix childrens hospital coruption. I exhausted my resources to fight to reunify our family. This has left invisible scars and trama.
— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn us apart and taken time away we will never get back
— TIANA

To prove Domestic Violance through victum services that was supposed to protect you as the victim. Failed misrable. As criminal has to have 7/8 misdemeanors before he is locked up. Court let abuser have my child for 2 yrs now. I have not seen her talked to her nothing.
— ESTE

False allegations are dismissed and never dealt with. These have gone on for years never proven. The allegations have had my kids removed from school multiple times and interviewed. Constant exposure to police. Court has limited my time with just one kid of 5 without looking at [...]
— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The inability for this judge to show equal accountability has prolonged my divorce for the better part of a decade. I have lost nearly everything in this process to include the ability to provide a stable life for my kids.
— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Arizona Family court had taken everything. My children, career, home, life savings and peace.
— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my life. I literally fought for my life and lost
— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Stolen our lives and stole from our future , over 1miion dollars in 4 years time lost never to be returned .*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Ashley Halvorson and Kolette Butler Psychologist, JD, PsyD seem to be bias to mom. My ex works for the MCBA I am a patient of Teri Hourihan

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took away the confidence in the only thing I could say proudly and that was “was a good mom”

— REBECCA

The system has disrupted my children’s lives. I have stayed on top of fighting what is right, yet, they refuse to make the appropriate best interest findings. My children were gone for 7 months. Missed 40% of a school year because of negligence. They failed to act!

— ERIC

Based on the fictitious allegations of a scorned mother, this system has allowed her to use my son as a pawn to hurt me, even though it ultimately hurts him even more. I suspect the judge's palms are being greased due to complete bias being shown in court, mirrored in the way [...]

— DOMINIC

Systematic destruction of the family unit for profit. These people look at us like cattle and sheep to make money off our children’s suffering ! Brood of vipers !

— ROBERT

Az "family" court has devastated me financially. I have been able to avoid bankruptcy only by taking tens of thousands out of my retirement account, borrowing from family and by doing debt consolidation which has ruined my credit. Since I have had over 5 years of only seeing my [...]

— LAURA

My daughter was taken away directly after birth due to having a flat affect. Crazy! My daughter is 26 now. I missed her whole entire life. A cps worker who was young as can be with no kids was.in my home telling me how to budget my money. Ive never been late on a bill in my [...]

— CANDICE

My experience with the family court system has been one of revictimization rather than protection. After escaping abuse, I found myself caught in years of litigation that prolonged the trauma, consumed my resources, and robbed me of irreplaceable time with my child, leaving me [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

69 Arizona parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ARIZONA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Arizona families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> My abusive, dx NPD, undx ASPD, never-working ex, his flying monkeys, corrupt CPS (who ignored court interviewer, kids' teacher, and my kids but should have helped us get free from my ex) and corrupt family court have completely and totally destroyed my children, our loving parent-child bonds, and me. Their horrible decisions and abuse of power, putting our lives and pets and assets in the complete coercive control of my abusive ex, cost the life of one of our cats and has cost us almost everything my kids and I worked for our whole lives, and may ultimately cost us our lives.
>
> — ELISABETH

> We have been alienated from each other, I was forced to abandon, because of threats and interigation tactics to my children. I cant control what cps is doing to my children, while I am not present in their life, they have to pretend to hate me to appease the father, court, casa, lawyers, gaurdian and cps. They have stolen more than words, money or anything that can be bought. The time lost is unimaginable. I wouldn't wish this pain on someone I hated. I cried myself to sleep for the first 2 years. Now im becoming numb to it, because my only choice is to quit, despite what my heart and soul want. In the end, my kids are suffering from this, so much. I hope we can repair and heal someday. Two years ago, when I started this fight, I was very hopeful. Now, im just waiting for them to be 18. Only 1.5 years left. For one child and 3.5 for the other. I have been pushed aside, told to forget about them, told to move on, told im not good enough, I have went to court every 3 months just to be told my kids hate me, despite their attempts to be part of my life. Gaurdian doesnt want that to happen. She thinks she has a relationship with my ex husband. She plans on holding my kids hostage until he is released from prison. So much more to this story. So much corruption, I have witnessed in the court room. With cps, funding and group homes. 4 different judges in 2 years. 2 different attorneys. 1 cps supervisor and 4 different cps workers. Cps worker admits on a recording, that she doesnt write the reports. They dont even know what the realistic allegations are. Im not sure who wakes up on a daily basis, for the purpose of destroying another human. It seems to be a dcs requirement, in
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

> Mohave County, AZ.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

> Family Court and CPS have damaged the mental health of my children. There should be accountability for Judges, Attorneys, Pychologist, to are not doing what is in the best interest of the Children.
>
> — MANUEL

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Destroyed it. Evil abuser had everything granted. Children are abused and I'm controlled
>
> — LAUREN

> It has destroyed mine and my wife life and we are still crying and wishing that we could be with him and his brothers and sisters that are younger than he is he will be turning 13 in May. I have three other kids ranging from five years old, and 12 years old and my kids love to see him. They go to school and see them and sometimes they'll go to their grandma's house and see him, but I cannot have anything to do with my son that CPS took from me. They lied to the court system and I wanted to file a lawsuit on them, but I could not find an attorney to do that because it is hard to fight the government, so nobody wanted to fight the government. I still cry and really concerned about my son. I know he is taking care of by my mother-in-law, but my mother-in-law and father-in-law don't want me to have anything to do with him. I'm not hurts me a lot.
>
> — JOHN

> Destroyed my family. abused the children. Tortured and extorted me as a father.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have 4 beautiful Daughters, From SA came here in 1999 - Imme grating and fought the court for 15 yrs to get Asylum - Got asylum in 2015 then got Citizenship 2019. Ex has used my children as leverage against me many years. Use them to keep me in line and told my children and friends many years that he will divorce me and take my children and leave me without financials. Counseling through the church many years as the abuse was fiscally mentally emotionally and spiritually. Extreme narcissistic character placed me in a victim mode for many years. That increased as he was in a plane crash with my middle daughter in Nebraska in 2022 October then had a Tree Lumb on his head. That increased his ability to make my children even more emotional trauma bonded to him as he says to them, he will die soon. For many years the Threating of Divorce was a manipulation tactic to get what he wants me to be and act. The Divorce started in 23 for 6 months. Then Christina 12 was already programmed to alienated me and he told her I was abandoning them. For years I was the Main caregiver homeschooled my daughters and now Christina was left in home alone. She was groomed and alienated from me since 2023 very much. For 6 moths I could not be in her life and he cut me off - Did called the Sheriff telling them I need my child. They said we need to fight it in court. Then we came back together again. He promised me that he will never do that again. We went to counseling at church again but the abuse kept going and I was made out as the villine again. Ex will call older daughters and tell them with Christina there that I am the problem and busy destroying the marriage. He used her to help him with
>
> — ESTE (1/2)

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

taking my phone from me and tell her to get my ipad and delet the videos I took of him hurting me and almost broke my arm as he threw me off the tiolet. Asked Christina to help him move all my clothes and belongings out my room. They will throw me out the house lock me out and then I cannot come back in. While I said I will call the Sheriff and then made out as a horrible mom for calling the Sheriff on him. Till the Morning of the 19th of Nov 2024 4:30am he started in on me and want me to hold him, and I needed to get up for a long day. He got mad and I went to bathroom and he started in on me and then corner me in the bathroom - Christina screamed let mom out and he threw my phone under the door to her say delete Moms pictures and videos off there. He called his Attorney 6:30 in morning leaving a demanding Message he is divorcing me start back up the case. Then my oldest and her husband took Christina for the day as I was a mess. That was the Last day I saw her. She went to my other daughter in Tuscan for a week and then I kept asking to have her through the older children, but they are manipulated by my husband. Brainwashed to the extreme as he told them you never call the Sherrif on your own family. He surely doesn't say I was the one who called the Attorney first. Domestic cases and Continual Harassment cases was dismissed. And I still have not seen my daughter after having a Therapeutic Interventionalist for 6 months and still I did not have time with my daughter. Also do not have my grandchildren after I was watching them every day for 2 years. Ex watches them play with them and I get told I can't see them till the divorce is over.

— ESTE (2/2)

My now adult children are now forever traumatized and broken with anxiety and depression from being ripped away from me for a year. After i was their primary caretaker for the first 10 years of their lives.

— MOLLY

Put my children back in the hands of their abuser

— ELIZABETH

Generationally life changing for children and families because of a corrupt Family Court system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Holidays, religious and cultural ties maliciously fractured, birthday, sporting events, special milestones were taken. Total erasure of a safe and loving parent, parental alienation through other party manipulation, isolating child with coercice control breaking child's cultural identify and family ties through isolation from the abusive parent. Silver bullet tactic was used by perpetrator, false allegations from other party with no findings, I documented hisory of DV asked of the court, bringing to light abuse, I was pro se not understanding the family court process. Denied several Motions without a Hearing. Blatantly disregarded years of proven DV of accusing parent, disregard of state law, No due process allowed, This judge allowed his clerk court to tamper court documents to cover up lack of due process, full disregard of contempt motion of custodial interference. Encouraged abusive parent in alienation tactics through working in court order.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This cost me two years of no contact my son, and it has subjected my son to abuse and has caused him tremendous strain and anxiety
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has taken for beautiful children that will well taken care of from my son and separated them from their grandparents and their family they have no communication with us and we were in their lives since the day they were born now we can't see them we can't speak to him we can't visit them our love on them when they need us the most they are scared and alone without any parents to stand for them the judge has taken my whole family and destroyed it doesn't care that my son can't live without his children his whole life is his four sons now we have nothing you have broken up a family that was being loved for cared for now we have no grandchildren in our lives no Love no happiness you have killed us we have destroyed our family you don't care that you have destroyed a family that was not even in need of your help
>
> — JOSETTE

> My grandson was suspected to sexual abuse and meth exposure for years. I was not allowed to see him until he was grown
>
> — PATRICIA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Judges ignored DV, financial abuse, coercive control, COA ignored children's testimony of abuse. DCS does nothing but threaten and play devils advocate instead of protecting the child. Judge orders counselors and CIA's to prolong costs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed the bond with my son and I and placed him in the hands of a felon

— MYKELA

They permanently altered my life and my young 3 sons" lives. Not only did they steal our time, which we will never get back, but they let our abuser walk away without any consequences or accountability. The trauma inflicted on us will never leave our story,

— LACEY

The system has used my family to farm out drug testing, behavior health services and then my daughter was thrown to my abuser even though they knew the circumstances. They were "legal kidnappers" in Havana's county. The t-shirts they made can still be seen in photos online

— LEIGH

My babies never experienced trauma until they were removed from my home.

— DANIELA

"I survived abuse only to be betrayed by the very system sworn to protect us. Family Court and CPS punish mothers for protecting their children, twisting fear into guilt and love into crime. They can take my children, but they will never take my truth, my voice, or the justice we deserve. With God on our side we will fight until we Are heard and reunification of our children is granted."

— MELISSA

Devastating physical and psychological damage to my son. Years of unimaginable trauma for both us

— MICHELLE

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Absolute devastation, PTSD, financial ruin, psychological warfare. The court system has allowed my abusive ex to legally and financially bully and abuse me for years.

— RENEE

They victimized the victim, which was me. I was a victim of dv , abuse, narcissistic control and they came after me. My children's only caretaker. Made my husband a saint.

— DESIREE

Destroyed my family, tore us apart and kept going. it will. be s miracle if our parent child relationship is ever restored.

— SUMMER

A donor who leaves for a substantial amount of time even though there is a court order for parenting time should NOT be able to just pick and choose to reappear whenever it's convenient for him and push law enforcement agencies into enforcing orders that the children have not been doing for years! These kids are being abused psychologically, physically, emotionally, & massive "threat and intimidation of children" while at his home!!! I could not get them into my car at first to even do the visits! This was ok with the donor "sometimes" (whenever he chose it was ok)—-then he started calling the police on ME for not getting them to the meeting spot. My kids are terrified to go & physically fighting not to get into my car! How is this normal and ok!!????? I started having to get them into the car THEN tell them where we were going as I was told I could be arrested for not getting them there!!!! Once there they screamed and cried and would not get out of my car to go! I called law enforcement to just be there to overlook and so there would be documentation of the incident and I was told that I was going to end up going to jail AND the officer told me "he would be in court to testify that dad get full custody of my kids" WHAT????? This officer has no idea what he's talking about! No back story, nothing!!! My poor babies are being terrorized and abused and I can do nothing about it!!! Multiple DCS calls made, even by their school! I am not getting a break when they are gone, I'm terrified I'm going to get a phone call! I can't sleep and I have to work! They take their phones now when they are there. Now they have NO protection!!! I'm lost! Nowhere to turn!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Total family annihilation. Financial and emotional.

— SHANNON

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My child was medically kidnapped, mentally and physically abused by dcs and phoenix childrens hospital coruption. I exhausted my resources to fight to reunify our family. This has left invisible scars and trama.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn us apart and taken time away we will never get back

— TIANA

To prove Domestic Violance through victum services that was supposed to protect you as the victim. Failed misrable. As criminal has to have 7/8 misdemeanors before he is locked up. Court let abuser have my child for 2 yrs now. I have not seen her talked to her nothing.

— ESTE

False allegations are dismissed and never dealt with. These have gone on for years never proven. The allegations have had my kids removed from school multiple times and interviewed. Constant exposure to police. Court has limited my time with just one kid of 5 without looking at evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The inability for this judge to show equal accountability has prolonged my divorce for the better part of a decade. I have lost nearly everything in this process to include the ability to provide a stable life for my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Arizona Family court had taken everything. My children, career, home, life savings and peace.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my life. I literally fought for my life and lost

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stolen our lives and stole from our future , over 1miion dollars in 4 years time lost never to be returned .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Ashley Halvorson and Kolette Butler Psychologist, JD, PsyD seem to be bias to mom. My ex works for the MCBA I am a patient of Teri Hourihan

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took away the confidence in the only thing I could say proudly and that was “was a good mom”

— REBECCA

The system has disrupted my children’s lives. I have stayed on top of fighting what is right, yet, they refuse to make the appropriate best interest findings. My children were gone for 7 months. Missed 40% of a school year because of negligence. They failed to act!

— ERIC

Based on the fictitious allegations of a scorned mother, this system has allowed her to use my son as a pawn to hurt me, even though it ultimately hurts him even more. I suspect the judge's palms are being greased due to complete bias being shown in court, mirrored in the way that all motions requested by mother are granted and every single motion requested by my attorney (typically for the same essential types of discovery) are denied. The stress has hurt my physical health (I now have a heart condition), the time it has taken from work has effected my business, my financial well-being, and, most importantly, it has cost me precious time with my son that has spanned over half of his life.

— DOMINIC

Systematic destruction of the family unit for profit. These people look at us like cattle and sheep to make money off our children’s suffering ! Brood of vipers !

— ROBERT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Az "family" court has devastated me financially. I have been able to avoid bankruptcy only by taking tens of thousands out of my retirement account, borrowing from family and by doing debt consolidation which has ruined my credit. Since I have had over 5 years of only seeing my children supervised/for 12 hours a month, my relationship with my children has been completely destroyed. My boys are now 12 and 14 and don't want to see me as the visits are contrived, limited by location, time and activity and because they are interrogated by their father and stepmother when they return to them after visits. My health has suffered significantly over the past decade of court involvement and I have been diagnosed with suicide ideation, depression, anxiety and adjustment disorder...all soley related to "family" court/custody involvement.

— LAURA

My daughter was taken away directly after birth due to having a flat affect. Crazy! My daughter is 26 now. I missed her whole entire life. A cps worker who was young as can be with no kids was.in my home telling me how to budget my money. Ive never been late on a bill in my entire life. Years later that cps worker was a patient at the psychiatric hospital I worked at. She approached me and apologized. I walked away and never spoke to her.

— CANDICE

My experience with the family court system has been one of revictimization rather than protection. After escaping abuse, I found myself caught in years of litigation that prolonged the trauma, consumed my resources, and robbed me of irreplaceable time with my child, leaving me feeling isolated and unprotected.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has cost my daughter her sense of security, he safe space. I will never stop fighting to rebuild that.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed my abuser to continue the abuse. He said he would “crush and destroy” me through court, 22 months and counting he’s doing his best.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have been fighting the Nevada and Arizona court system for my daughter for the last 6 1/2 years. I am a present involved father and they have changed judges 4 times. Approved numerous continuances just to drag this out as long as possible.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We are in purgatory right now. We don't have temporary orders and my divorce has had no progress since filing 8 months ago.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Keeping Our Children form being in a home that supports their growth and education vs. spending more time with Daycare/School than family. Our kids are different in school and the other parent's home than they are at mine, up to being nervous for the other parent to see them even happy in my presence during mutual events.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Prolonged litigation costing a fortune. Ex was granted temporary parenting time when we already had a rule 69 permanent plan in place, without hearing my evidence and told unreasonable and would be forced to pay attorney fees if I didn't agree

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The PO Should never have authority to allow a child sex offender to move in with someone else's children. We need to fix the system In Arizona. 4 and 5 year old should not be forced to see the other parent is there is a chance that other parent could manipulate them into not telling the truth.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Do you see us cannot write a report correctly they drag they even dragging their feet about everything not even doing their job most of the time

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It left me devastated, how does someone that has done everything right for their kid, end up getting their child taken by the parent that was almost never involved in her life. I was a single mom providing emotionally, financially and physically yet he can make a false statement and just like that, take the child I raised all by my own? Crazy!

— KARISHA

A year after hiring my attorney to modify parenting time because I discovered my ex was sexually abusive, we still have 50/50 custody, my child's mental health has severely declined, and I cannot afford to retain a new attorney.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Well my father said my child will be the one to make it through but me I'm not sure that our daughter will. No attorney wanted to be willing to take on the govt they just said when they say jump u say how high.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has almost destroyed my current marriage and has alienated my baby girl from her 3 other younger siblings and myself (her mom) She is so young. She was in kindergarten. It's hurt all of us tremendously.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Child Protection services? Instead of protection we got seperation, fear and trama. DCS didn't investigate my family they disrupted it, trust was damaged, and the sense of safety was taken away.

— SHEENA

They separated my infant and gave him to the hands of our abuser. Who continues to psychologically manipulate my toddler against me. Our secure attachment was broken, and I have to watch my child suffer and there's nothing I can do about it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has completely ruined my entire life, my dignity, my self-respect, my right to life...to live in the enjoyment of life, peace, liberty, happiness, and have not only basic necessities but the standard of living I had before. It has left me homeless & below poverty. It has completely ruined my relationship with the loves of my life, my 2 kids. I have lost time. Time with my kids, time to work, time to work on getting Justice, time to enjoy life itself. I have lost myself. Complete destroyment of my life!!

— ERIKA

After 22 years of trying to come from my daughter they now have kidnapped my granddaughter when my daughter was a rape victim

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court was nothing short of another beating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court's actions resulted in the separation of my entire side of the family from my daughter and have caused severe financial hardship. We miss her deeply; her absence is a constant and profound loss.

— WHITTNI

I watched my happy, healthy, beautiful children become shells of themselves as they slowly lost faith that they would ever be saved from the darkness the system entrusted to protect them placed them in. My boys lost their childhood, their innocence and their belief in humanity at the hands of bad actors who saw my children as opportunities to profit.

— RACHEL

In the past nine years, I have spent over $25,000 in a family court system that has prioritized equal parenting time over the voices and well-being of my children. They were denied the opportunity to grow up in their home state with their extended family and instead were required to participate in arrangements they did not want. This has caused ongoing emotional strain and a loss of stability during critical years of their childhood. The financial cost has been measurable—the human cost has not.

— TARYN

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Continue delaying tactics. Saying i have to follow this process but putting noting in place so I can have my chilf, without spending money to fly 2000 miles to MN to see them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Two judicial officers found that the harm to me was real: Commissioner Ash expressly held that the message to my employer "rose to the level of harassment" and that she could not imagine where it "would've come from" other than the person I named, while Judge Halvorson's order repeats "no credible evidence presented" across the very findings the record contradicts, yet each then ruled against me anyway, Ash by recasting my pursuit of protection as a tactic "for the sole purpose of seeking an advantage" and Halvorson by treating documented exclusion, unilateral decisions, and a falsified provider record as if they did not exist. The net effect is that the system acknowledged the conduct against me in its own words and still denied me relief, leaving a father labeled the aggressor on a record that, read honestly, shows the opposite.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They didn't protect my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was targeted due to lack of knowledge and It cost me my whole entire life and purpose to living. I lost the greatest joy I enjoyed doing and being is a mother! "Educate yourself, & instead of answering their questions ask them a question to their questions. And most importantly DO NOT SIGN NOT A SINGLE THING, NOT EVEN INITIAL until you have full clarity of what your signing."

— DESTINY

I have never been more disrespected and humiliated in my entire life i am 55 years old and have never been away from daughter her entire life up till 18 months ago. This judge has mantly reprimand and told me there are no morals in his courtroom then proceeded to make fun of my math skills I have many comments from local page on said judge and his unethical conduct inside and outside of the courtroom. Im so depressed and mentally distraught I dont know what to do. Its like im living in a horrible film or a communist country. I work in the federal government amongst law enforcement and never in my life thought a human being could make such decisions for my family life without even blinking an eye. This system is designed to make good people turn bad on purpose for profit period.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Allowed continued DV via the court system. Suppressed and denied consideration of evidence to prove violation of disclosure and trend of perjury. Failed to acknowledge and consider the extraordinary needs of a special needs child. Refused to enforce orders made by the court after the orders were violated consistently per evidence provided, over the duration of litigation. Court punished the party victim to disparity of income and their ex withholding communal assets that otherwise, would have allowed the resources to expedite the divorce proceedings.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The first day without my daughter for the first time in jail, I realized life would never be the same. I see that now I'm the adult but the little person watching us suffers so much more that the pain I feel is only compounded more and more each day. Knowing I would rather have never experienced the joy of her than to have made her endure this and suffer. It's... insanity inducing the hurdles, the obstacles the clear need for control and debilitation of someone you made a child with. I feel like I'm being paraded through the streets and I know the system perpetuates this... I couldn't have predicted this.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

69 full approved Arizona comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arizona report comes from Arizona respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arizona — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 97 Arizona families reporting here are not the universe of Arizona families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

STANDWITHMEG.COM | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.